

DECATHLON

Sales & Customer Analytics

Dashboard Walkthrough

Document Purpose: Provide a practical, recruiter-ready walkthrough of the Excel dashboard, explaining its layout, KPIs, filters, visuals, analytical flow, and how a business user can use it to answer key commercial questions.

Project Item	Details
Project	Decathlon Sales & Customer Analytics
Platform	Microsoft Excel
Dataset	30,000 synthetic retail transactions
Analysis Period	2024–2026
Primary Focus	Sales, customers, products, sports, channels, trends
Audience	Business analysts, sales managers, category managers, management
Dashboard Type	Interactive executive analytics dashboard

This walkthrough describes the intended analytical experience of the dashboard and is designed to accompany the project report and business requirements document.

1. Dashboard Purpose

The dashboard converts transaction-level retail data into a concise management view. Instead of requiring users to inspect thousands of rows, it presents the most important commercial KPIs and visual trends in one place.

The dashboard follows a simple analytical journey: What happened → Where did it happen → Who drove it → What should the business investigate next?

2. Recommended Dashboard Layout

Section	Purpose
Header / Title	Establish project context and reporting scope.
Filter Area	Allow users to select Year and Month.
KPI Cards	Provide immediate performance indicators.
Sports / Category Visuals	Identify leading revenue drivers.
Trend Visual	Show how sales change over time.
Customer Section	Understand customer base and retention.
Channel / Gender Section	Compare customer and channel contribution.
Insight Area	Translate patterns into business actions.

3. Dashboard Navigation Flow

Step	User Action	Question Answered
1	Open dashboard	How is the business performing overall?
2	Review KPI cards	What are the current sales and customer levels?
3	Check sports/categories	Which product areas generate the most value?
4	Review sales trend	When are sales increasing or declining?
5	Review customer metrics	Who contributes to performance and how well are customers retained?
6	Compare channels	Which selling channels are strongest?
7	Apply filters	Does the story change for a selected year or month?
8	Read insights	What action or further analysis should management consider?

4. KPI Cards — Executive Performance

The KPI area is designed to be the first analytical checkpoint. Users should be able to understand the overall state of the business within a few seconds.

KPI	What It Shows	Business Interpretation
Total Sales	Total value of reported sales.	Overall revenue performance.
Total Orders	Unique order volume.	Demand and transaction activity.
Total Customers	Unique customers.	Size of the customer base.
Average Order Value	Average sales per order.	Customer basket / order quality.
Total Profit	Profit generated.	Commercial profitability.
Profit Margin	Profit as a share of sales.	Efficiency of revenue generation.

How to use: Start with the KPI cards, then move to the supporting visuals. A KPI should never be interpreted in isolation; for example, higher sales with falling margin may indicate discounting or cost pressure.

5. Year & Month Filters

The dashboard should provide Year and Month selectors so users can move from the complete reporting period to a specific period. These filters are particularly useful for investigating seasonality, unusual peaks, and changes in customer or product performance.

Filter	Typical Use
Year	Compare annual performance and identify year-over-year movement.
Month	Investigate short-term sales changes and seasonal patterns.
Combined filters	Analyze a specific month within a selected year.

6. Sales Trend Visual

The monthly sales trend provides the time-series view of the dashboard. It should make peaks, declines, and recurring patterns visually obvious.

Business questions answered:

- Are sales growing or declining over time?
- Which months generate the strongest sales?
- Are there unusual spikes or dips?
- Does the selected year behave differently from the overall period?

The trend should be read together with promotions, product categories, and channel performance where available.

7. Top Sports Analysis

The Top Sports visual ranks sports by sales performance. It is intended to identify the areas of the assortment that contribute most strongly to revenue.

Analysis	Interpretation
Top 5 sports	Shows the highest-value sports at a glance.
Ranking gaps	Highlights whether performance is concentrated or distributed.
Filter response	Shows whether the leading sports change by year or month.

Example business use: If one sport consistently dominates sales, category managers can investigate assortment depth, inventory availability, promotions, and customer demand within that sport.

8. Product Category Analysis

Category analysis moves one level deeper than sport-level performance. It helps identify which types of products are driving sales and where the business may have opportunities to improve the assortment.

Recommended interpretation sequence:

1. Identify the largest categories.
2. Compare their contribution to total sales.
3. Check whether category leadership changes over time.
4. Cross-reference strong categories with customer segments and channels.

9. Customer Analytics

The customer section provides a view of who is purchasing and how customer behavior contributes to business performance.

Metric / View	Purpose
Customer Count	Understand the size of the active customer base.
Customer Segment	Compare contribution across customer groups.
Retention	Assess the ability to retain customers.
Gender	Compare sales contribution by gender.
Average Order Value	Understand basket value at customer/order level.

Customer metrics should be interpreted alongside sales and order activity. A growing customer count does not automatically mean stronger profitability if order value or retention is weakening.

10. Sales Channel Analysis

Channel analysis compares performance across the available sales channels, such as website, physical store, and mobile application.

Question	Why It Matters
Which channel generates the most sales?	Helps prioritize channel investment.
Which channel has stronger order activity?	Shows where customers transact most frequently.
Does channel mix change over time?	Can reveal changing customer preferences.
Do product leaders differ by channel?	Can inform channel-specific merchandising.

11. Dashboard Interactivity

The dashboard should behave as an analytical tool rather than a static report. When a user changes a filter, dependent visuals should update consistently.

Interaction	Expected Behavior
Select Year	KPIs and charts update to the selected year.
Select Month	Relevant visuals update to the selected month.
Clear filters	Dashboard returns to the overall reporting view.
Hover / inspect chart	Users can identify the underlying category or period value where supported.

12. Reading the Dashboard as a Business Analyst

A strong analysis should not stop at identifying the highest number. Use the dashboard to build a chain of reasoning:

What? Identify a movement in sales or customers.

Why? Investigate sports, categories, customers, or channels that may explain it.

Where? Determine the segment, channel, or period where the movement is concentrated.

What next? Recommend an action or a deeper analysis.

This approach transforms the dashboard from a reporting artifact into a decision-support tool.

13. Example Analytical Walkthrough

Step	Example Observation	Follow-up
1. KPI review	Sales are strong but profit margin is lower.	Investigate discounting and product mix.
2. Trend review	A particular month shows a large sales spike.	Check promotions, categories, and channels.
3. Sports review	One sport is the leading revenue contributor.	Review assortment and stock availability.
4. Customer review	Retention differs across customer segments.	Investigate segment-specific engagement.
5. Channel review	One channel contributes a large share of sales.	Assess channel experience and growth opportunity.
6. Action	Prioritize the strongest drivers and investigate weak points.	Build targeted business recommendations.

14. Visual Design Principles

Principle	Dashboard Application
Hierarchy	KPI cards first, analysis visuals second, detailed insights last.
Clarity	Use short chart titles and meaningful metric labels.
Consistency	Keep number formats, fonts, spacing, and alignment consistent.
Minimalism	Avoid excessive decoration that competes with the data.
Comparability	Use consistent scales when comparing categories.
Accessibility	Maintain readable text and sufficient contrast.

15. Data & KPI Validation Checklist

Check	Expected Result
Sales total	Matches SUM(Final_Amount).
Order count	Matches distinct Order_ID count.
Customer count	Matches distinct Customer_ID count.
AOV	Equals Total Sales ÷ Total Orders.
Profit	Matches approved Profit calculation.
Filters	Update relevant KPI and visual values.
Categories	No unexpected blank or duplicate labels.

16. Business Insights the Dashboard Can Support

The dashboard is designed to support questions such as:

- Which sports and categories are the strongest revenue drivers?
- How does sales performance change by month and year?
- Which customer groups contribute most to sales?
- Is customer retention improving or weakening?
- Which sales channel deserves additional attention?
- Are high-sales periods also delivering strong profitability?
- Where should management investigate inventory, promotions, or customer engagement?

17. Recommended Business Actions

Insight Type	Potential Action
Strong sport/category	Review inventory depth, assortment, and merchandising.
Weak category	Investigate demand, pricing, visibility, and assortment fit.
High sales / low margin	Review discounts, costs, and product mix.
Low retention	Develop targeted customer engagement and retention campaigns.
Strong channel	Invest in customer experience and channel scalability.
Seasonal peak	Prepare inventory and marketing resources before peak periods.

18. Recommended Presentation Flow

When presenting this project to a recruiter, interviewer, or business stakeholder, use the following sequence:

1. Introduce the business problem.
2. Explain the dataset and analytical scope.
3. Start with executive KPIs.
4. Show sales trends and top sports/categories.
5. Move into customer and channel behavior.
6. Demonstrate filtering and interactivity.
7. Explain two or three meaningful business insights.
8. Finish with recommendations and limitations.

19. Limitations

The dashboard is based on synthetic data created for educational and portfolio purposes. The insights should therefore be treated as demonstrations of analytical methodology rather than claims about actual Decathlon business performance.

The current solution is also primarily descriptive and diagnostic. Forecasting, predictive modeling, real-time data refresh, and enterprise-scale deployment are outside the current scope.

20. Final Dashboard Walkthrough Summary

The Decathlon Sales & Customer Analytics dashboard provides an executive-friendly path from overall performance to detailed commercial drivers. Users begin with KPIs, investigate time and category trends, understand customer and channel behavior, apply filters, and convert observations into business questions and actions.

The strongest portfolio value of the dashboard is not simply the number of visuals, but the analytical story it tells: performance → drivers → customer behavior → channel behavior → action.

Prepared as a Business Analytics Portfolio Project

Data Disclaimer: Synthetic data is used for educational and portfolio purposes. This document does not represent official Decathlon customer, sales, financial, or operational information.